Note Taking

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Functional English (SS1012)

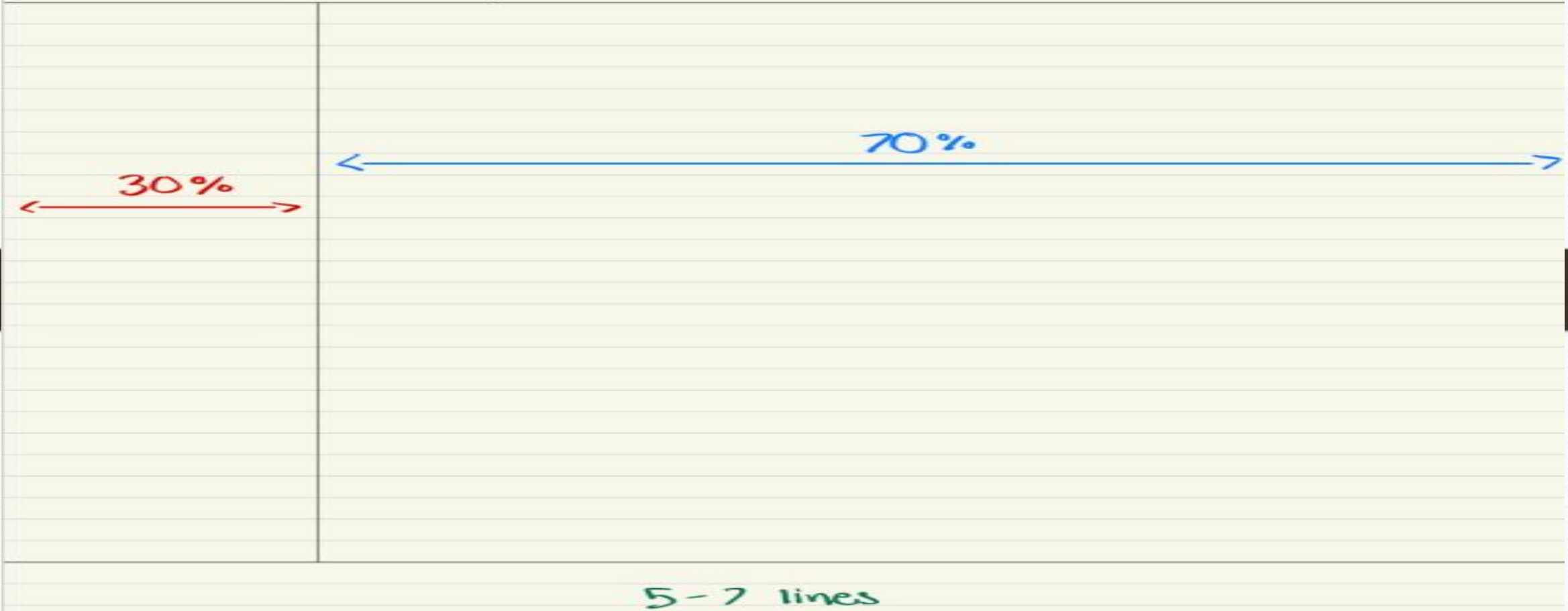
Why Note-taking is Essential

- **Memory Retention:** Explains how actively engaging with material by taking notes helps improve long-term memory.
- **Organization:** Notes help structure information logically, making it easier to review and recall later.
- **Focus and Engagement:** Taking notes encourages attentiveness during lectures or while reading.

1. Cornell Method:

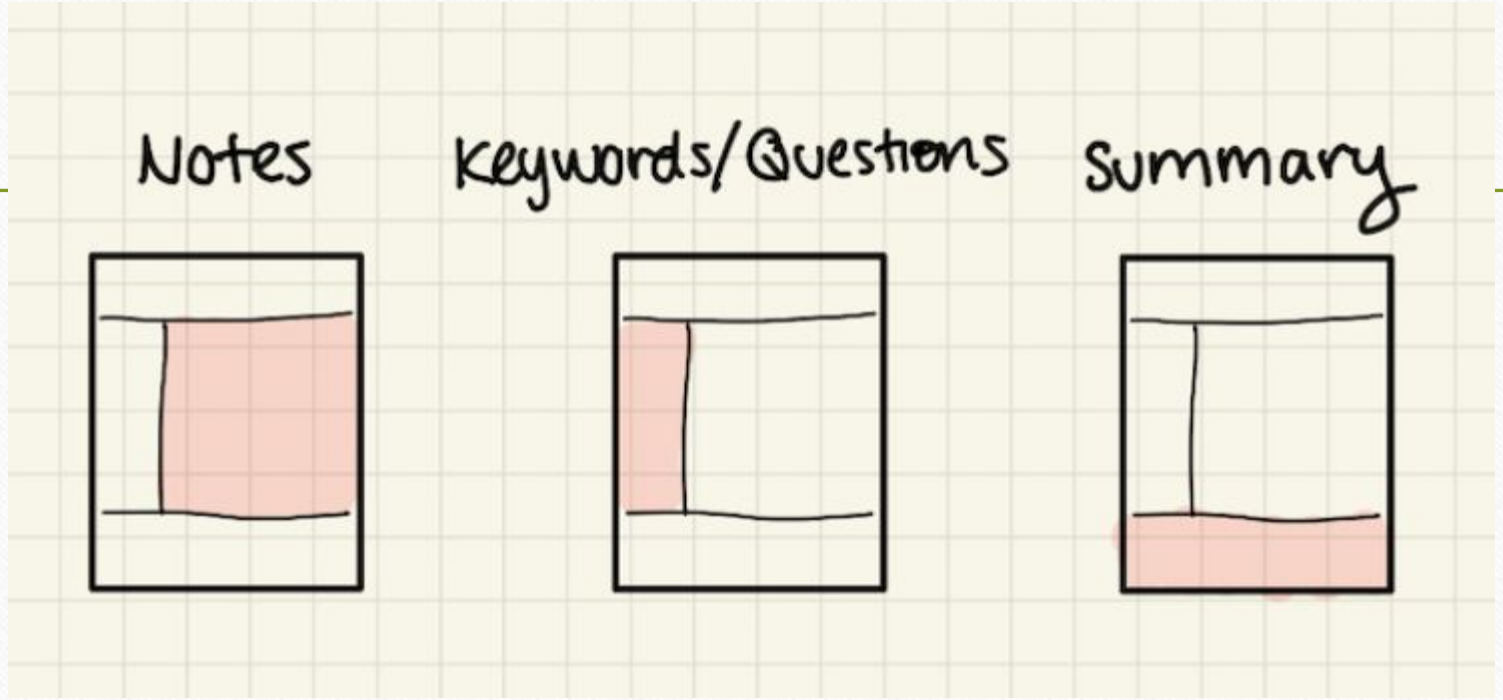
- **Format:** Split your page into three sections—cue, notes, and summary.
- **Usage:** Write main points in the notes section, cues for key terms or questions in the cue section, and a summary at the bottom.
- **Advantages:** Organized for easy review and especially helpful for exam preparation.

(optional title section)



5-7 lines

All actual notes from the lecture go into the main note-taking column.



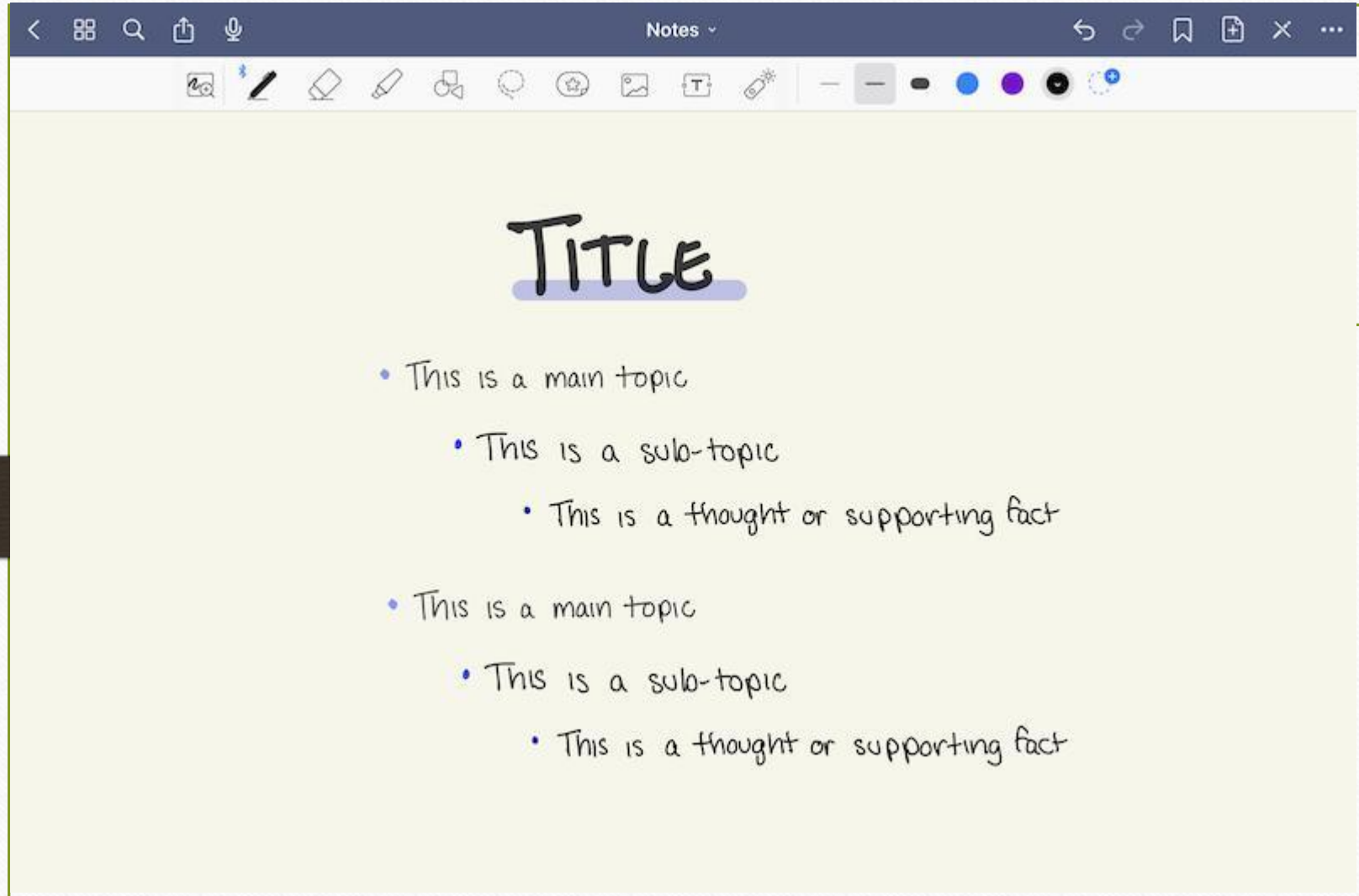
The smaller column on the left side is for keywords and questions

At the bottom of the page, write a brief summary of the content on the page.

2. Outline Method:

- **Here are just 4 simple steps to start writing outline notes:**

1. Write down a main point to the left of the page.
2. Indent to the right, and note any supporting ideas below it
3. Whenever you need to elaborate on a point, indent to the right and start adding new points below
4. Repeat



In outline notes, supporting ideas are nested under the point it's related to. You can keep going and create as many layers as you need or want.

With this layout, you can easily see the hierarchy of ideas, and how information relates to each other.

Benefits of the outline note-taking method

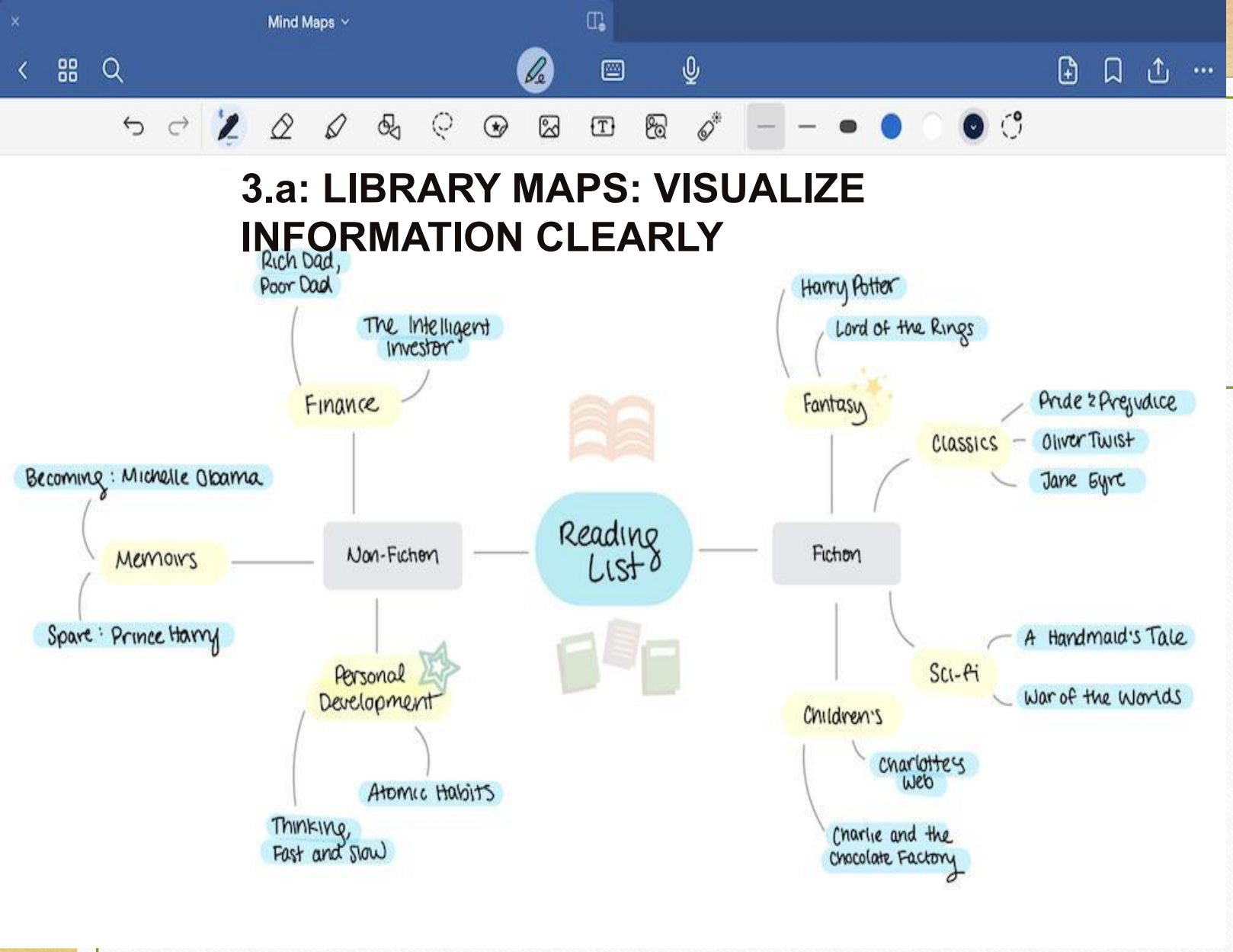
- They’re highly structured, logical, and easy-to-follow
- Visually, the nested points illustrate the hierarchy of ideas at-a-glance
- Easy to create. There’s no set up required or any special template needed

- **When should you use the outline method?**
  - The outline method is well-suited for topics that would usually use a lot of words (over visuals or equations) to explain. It helps break down big ideas logically.
- **When you shouldn’t use the outline method?**
  - Because it’s so structured, if you’re taking notes that require diagrams, visuals, or charts, the outline method won’t be the best choice.
  - The outline method is best for notes that are primarily written linearly using full sentences.

3. Mind Mapping

- **Library maps: Visualize information clearly**
- **Brace maps: Break down big ideas into small parts**

3.a: LIBRARY MAPS: VISUALIZE INFORMATION CLEARLY



Library maps are best used for organizing everything you need to know about a topic.

Visually, the map will look like a tree.

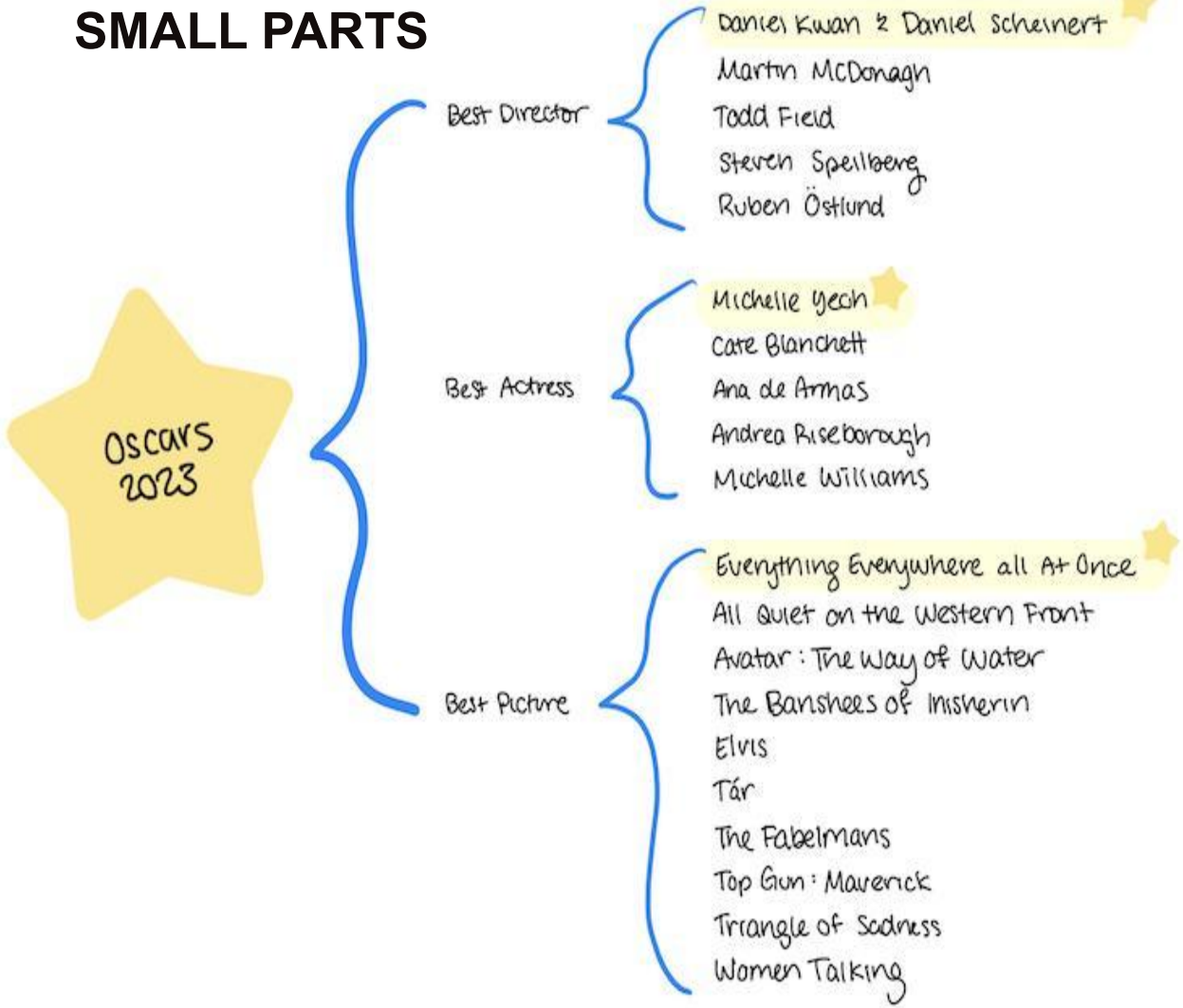
One node in the center will represent the main idea, with supporting ideas that branch out and have their own details attached.

When to use library mind mapping method

- Gathering and keeping track of information meant for deep dives into particular subjects
- Summarizing a lecture or class and using it for review before final exams
- You need a visual outline for writing cohesive essays that explore several ideas around a topic

Mind Maps

3.b: BRACE MAPS: BREAK DOWN BIG IDEAS INTO SMALL PARTS



When to use this mind mapping method

- Understanding part-to-whole relationships, such as labeling every part of a physical object or showing the ingredients needed for a recipe
- Literature, when keeping track of several characters based on relationships, locations, and time periods
- Illustrating hierarchy, like organizational charts in companies

Techniques for Effective Note-taking

- **Be Selective:** Focus on key points, concepts, and supporting details; avoid word for word notes unless a specific phrase or term is critical.
- **Use Abbreviations and Symbols:** Save time by using commonly understood shorthand (e.g., "w/" for "with," arrows for cause/effect).
- **Review and Refine Notes Regularly:** Revisiting and summarizing notes soon after taking them reinforces memory.
- **Highlight or Color Code:** Distinguish between main points, supporting details, and examples for easy reference.